

Git Workflow for Reviewers

Desk Instruction DI-GIT-001

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Purpose: This one-page instruction explains how to review, comment on, and approve changes using your web browser. No software installation required.

The 5-Step Review Workflow

1. Open URL → 2. Browse Files → 3. View Changes → 4. Comment → 5. Approve

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. **Open the project URL** in your browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari).
 - You will receive the URL by email or message from the project team.
 - Bookmark it for easy access.
2. **Browse files.** The project landing page shows all files. Click any file to see its contents. Click folders to navigate.
3. **View changes.** When someone proposes a change:
 - You will receive an email notification with a link.
 - Click the link to open the **Merge Request** (GitLab) or **Pull Request** (GitHub).
 - Click the “**Changes**” tab to see the diff.
 - **Choose your view:** *Inline* shows old and new together; *Side-by-side* shows old on the left, new on the right. Toggle this with the button at the top of the Changes tab. Side-by-side is often easier to read for large changes.
 - **Green lines** = text that was **added**.
 - **Red lines** = text that was **removed**.
 - Unchanged text is shown in gray for context.
4. **Leave a comment.** Click on any line in the diff to leave a comment. Ask questions, request changes, or note concerns. All comments are saved permanently.
5. **Approve.** When you are satisfied with the changes, click the “**Approve**” button. Once all required reviewers approve, the changes are merged into the official version.

Viewing History

To see previous versions of any file:

1. Open the file in your browser.
2. Click “**History**” (GitHub) or “**History**” (GitLab) in the top-right area.
3. Each entry shows: *who* changed it, *when*, and a *summary* of what changed.
4. Click any entry to see the exact changes made at that point.

Key Rules (Enforced Automatically)

Rule	What it means
No direct changes to main	All changes must go through a Merge/Pull Request
Required approvers	Changes cannot be merged until designated reviewers approve
Author cannot self-approve	The person who made the change cannot approve their own change
Stale approval reset	If changes are made after approval, reviewers must re-approve

Quick Reference

I want to...	Do this
See what changed	Open the Merge Request → click “Changes” tab
Ask a question	Click on a line in the diff → type your comment
Approve changes	Click “Approve” button on the Merge Request
See all versions	Open a file → click “History”
Compare two versions	Open History → click any entry to see that diff

Questions? Contact the project team. All actions are logged for compliance (NIST SP 800-53 CM-3, AC-5, AU-3).